

FRANCESCO SBRANA

PERSONAL

Hi! I am a PhD student at Collegio Carlo Alberto in Turin. I'm interested in Crime Economics, Conflict Studies and Applied Microeconomics in general. Feel free to contact me if needed! :)

EDUCATION

- Collegio Carlo Alberto and UniTo • **Vilfredo Pareto PhD in Economics** 2024 - current
Supervisors: Professor Elena Esposito and Professor Juan Vargas
 - University of Bologna • **MA in Economics and Econometrics** 2022 - 2024
Supervisor: Professor Paolo Vanin
Thesis title: *How Do Tough-on-Crime Policies Affect Economic Development? Evidence from El Salvador*
Final grade: 110/110 cum laude
 - University of Pisa • **BA in Business Administration** 2019 - 2022
Supervisor: Professor Cecilia Vergari
Thesis title: *Game Theory: Altruism and Social Norms in Non-Cooperative Games (translated)*
Final grade: 110/110 cum laude
 - ISCTE Business School • **Erasmus+** 2021 - 2022
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WORK IN PROGRESS

- **Being Tough on Crime: Effects on School Dropout**
This paper studies the effects of Honduras' "Mano Dura" policy on school dropout.
Preliminary results suggest that the crackdown reduced overall dropout by around 40% relative to the pre-treatment mean.
 - **Sand smuggling and social tensions**
 - **License to Kill: "War on Drugs" and social costs**
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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- **Research Assistant** for Prof. Elena Esposito and Prof. Andrea Gallice 2025 - current
Project on "Dehumanizing Narratives in Conflicts"
 - **Research Assistant** for Prof. Elena Esposito and Prof. Ada González-Torres 2025
Coding Tasks
 - **Research Assistant** for Prof. Carmine Guerriero 2023
Data collection for the ORIGIN'S project
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TEACHING

- **Econometric Theory II** (PhD course) • Collegio Carlo Alberto 2026
TA to Juan Vargas
 - **Microeconomics** (Undergraduate) • SAA - School of Management 2026
TA to Nadia Campaniello
 - **Introduction to Statistics** (Graduate) • University of Bologna 2023
Lecturer
 - **Calculus and Linear Algebra** (Undergraduate) • University of Bologna 2023 - 2024
TA to Lars Halvard Halle
 - **Statistics** (Undergraduate) • University of Bologna 2023 - 2024
TA to Maurizio Brizzi
 - **Statistics** (Undergraduate) • University of Pisa 2021 - 2022
TA to Lucio Masserini
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OTHER ROLES

- **PhD Representative** • Collegio Carlo Alberto 2025 - Current
- **PhD Representative** • ESOMAS Department (UniTo) 2025 - Current

SCHOOLS AND POST-GRADUATE COURSES

- **Summer School in International and Development Economics** • Centro Luca D'Agliano and CCA 2025
Topic: "Geo-economics, Natural Resources, and Development"
- **Training on counterfactual impact evaluation (CIE) methods** • JRC Ispra 2025

ADDITIONAL

- **Programming:** Stata, R, Python, Julia, QGIS, LaTeX
- **Languages:** Italian (native), English (TOEFL 100 • C1), Spanish (B1)
- **Other Certifications:** GRE (170)

REFERENCES

Professor Elena Esposito

Collegio Carlo Alberto, Junior Chair

Rita Levi Montalcini Researcher at ESOMAS, Department of Economics, University of Torino

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Professor Juan Vargas

Collegio Carlo Alberto, Carlo Alberto Chair

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